

Introduction to Open Source Models & WAN2GP

What Are Open Source Models?

Open source AI models are publicly available tools that anyone can use, modify, and run without licensing fees or subscription costs. Unlike proprietary platforms like Sora 2 or Veo 3, open source models give you complete control and zero ongoing costs.

The catch:

You need computing power to run them. Specifically, you need a good graphics card (GPU) to process the AI generations.

Why use open source models:

Completely free

Once you have the hardware

No subscriptions

No credit systems or monthly subscriptions

Full control

Full control over the models

Cutting edge

Access to cutting edge experimental features

Community driven

Community driven improvements

No restrictions

No usage restrictions

What Is WAN2GP?

WAN2GP is an open source platform that simplifies access to top tier open source AI models. Think of it as a user friendly interface that packages all the best open source video and image generation models into one simple tool.

What makes WAN2GP special:

Simple UI:

Unlike complicated ComfyUI workflows that require technical setup and node configuration, WAN2GP provides a clean, straightforward interface anyone can use.

Centralized access:

Instead of hunting down individual models, setting them up separately, and learning different workflows, WAN2GP puts everything in one place.

Top models included:

WAN2GP bundles the best performing open source models for video generation, image creation, and other AI tasks.

What you can do with WAN2GP:

- Generate AI videos
- Create images
- Process and enhance content
- Use cutting edge open source models
- All through one unified interface

How We'll Use WAN2GP in This Course

The following modules will teach you how to leverage WAN2GP for AI UGC creation and long form AI video content.

You'll learn:

- The top open source models currently available
- Which models work best for different use cases
- How to generate professional AI UGC using free tools
- Workflows for long form AI video content
- How to achieve results comparable to paid platforms

Two Ways to Run WAN2GP

Option 1: Run Locally (If You Have a Good Rig)

If you already have a powerful computer with a high end graphics card, you can run WAN2GP directly on your machine.

Requirements:

- Strong GPU (graphics card)
- Windows operating system (Macs typically cannot run WAN2GP)
- Sufficient RAM and storage

Setup: Download and install from the GitHub repository (link provided in course materials).

Advantage: Completely free operation. No ongoing costs once installed.

Option 2: Use Cloud GPUs (If You Don't Have a Good Rig)

Most people don't have the hardware to run these models locally. That's where cloud GPU services come in.

The solution: RunPod

RunPod is a cloud GPU rental service. You pay for GPU time as you use it, similar to renting computing power by the hour.

How it works:

1. Create a RunPod account
2. Add credits to your account
3. Select the WAN2GP template
4. Launch a cloud instance
5. Access WAN2GP through your browser

Why RunPod:

- Much cheaper than buying expensive hardware
- Pay only for what you use
- Access from any computer
- Pre-configured WAN2GP templates available
- Easy setup process

Setting Up WAN2GP with RunPod

The next module provides a complete walkthrough of:

01

Creating your RunPod account

02

Adding credits

03

Selecting and launching the WAN2GP template

04

Accessing your WAN2GP interface

05

Basic configuration and settings

Even if you've never used cloud GPUs before, the step by step guide makes the process straightforward.

Why This Matters for AI UGC

Open source models through WAN2GP give you an alternative to expensive proprietary platforms.

Cost comparison:

Proprietary platforms:

- Monthly subscriptions ($20 to $200+)
- Credit based systems
- Usage limits
- Ongoing costs

Open source via WAN2GP:

- Free if running locally
- Low hourly rates if using RunPod
- No usage limits beyond your budget
- One time learning curve

For high volume content creation, the savings add up quickly.

Top Open Source Models for AI UGC

The upcoming modules cover the best performing open source models currently available

Each model has specific strengths. You'll learn when to use each one for optimal results..

Getting Started

Before moving to the next module:

If you have a powerful Windows PC with a good GPU:

- Download WAN2GP from this github link: https://github.com/deepbeepmeep/Wan2GP
- Install locally
- Skip the RunPod setup module

If you don't have the hardware (most people):

- Proceed to the next module for RunPod setup
- Budget approximately $5 to $20 for initial testing credits
- Follow the step by step installation guide

The Bottom Line

WAN2GP gives you access to professional grade AI generation tools without expensive subscriptions or hardware purchases. Whether running locally or through RunPod, you'll have everything needed to create high quality AI UGC using open source models.

The learning curve is minimal thanks to WAN2GP's simplified interface. Within one setup session, you'll be generating content with models that rival or exceed proprietary platforms.

Let's get started with the setup process.